

MAY 2026

Washington County Real Estate Market Report: May 2026

Date Prepared: May 03, 2026



MARKET OVERVIEW

Market Snapshot

Washington County is shifting toward **balanced conditions** in April 2026 — strong price appreciation, rising inventory, and improved mortgage rates are reshaping the landscape for buyers and sellers alike.



Key Market Drivers

- Median price up **19.1%** year-over-year
- New listings surged **40.2%**
- Mortgage rates at **3-year lows** (6.30%)
- Unemployment at just **2.3–2.6%**

PRICE TRENDS

Median Sales Price: \$485,000

\$485K

Current Price

+19.1%

YoY Change

\$407K

April 2025

For Buyers

- Prices remain elevated — get pre-approved
- Rate drop improves purchasing power

For Sellers

- Strong appreciation supports list pricing
- Price strategically vs. new comps



MARKET SPEED

Days on Market: 20 Days

Current

20 days

Last Year

5 days

Change

+15 days

Homes are taking **4× longer** to sell than a year ago — buyers have more time to evaluate, but well-priced homes still move fast.

-  **Buyers:** More time for due diligence; less frenzied competition
-  **Sellers:** Plan for longer marketing periods; presentation matters

SUPPLY & DEMAND

Inventory & Months' Supply

239

Active Listings

+27.8% YoY

2.7mo

Months' Supply

Up from 1.9 mo

55%

Below Balanced

vs. 6-month norm

For Buyers

- More choices, less bidding-war pressure
- Room to negotiate terms

For Sellers

- Still a seller's market — supply below balance
- Price competitively to attract offers

PRICING POWER

Sale-to-List Price Ratio: 101.0%

Homes are selling **above asking price** — up from 100.4% last year. Buyers are still competing, even as the market normalizes.

Why It Matters

A ratio above 100% means sellers are receiving **more than list price** on average.



Market Implications

- **Buyers:** Budget above list price; expect competition
- **Buyers:** Less frenzied than prior years
- **Sellers:** Strong leverage on pricing
- **Sellers:** Accurate pricing drives multiple offers

NEW SUPPLY

New Listings: 164 Homes

Year-Over-Year

New listings surged **+40.2%** from 117 units in April 2025 — the largest supply increase in recent years, giving buyers significantly more options.



For Buyers: Best selection in years; shop with confidence

Why It Matters

Rising supply is the primary driver of market normalization, reducing urgency and extending decision timelines.



For Sellers: More competition — differentiate with staging & pricing

AFFORDABILITY ANALYSIS

Affordability & Income Context

\$106K

Median Income

~\$380K

Buying Power

28% DTI at 6.30%

\$485K

Median Price

 **For Buyers:** Median income supports strong qualification; wage growth (+4.5% YoY) helps close the gap

 **For Sellers:** Premium market — buyers are qualified and motivated despite elevated prices

Mortgage Rate Trend

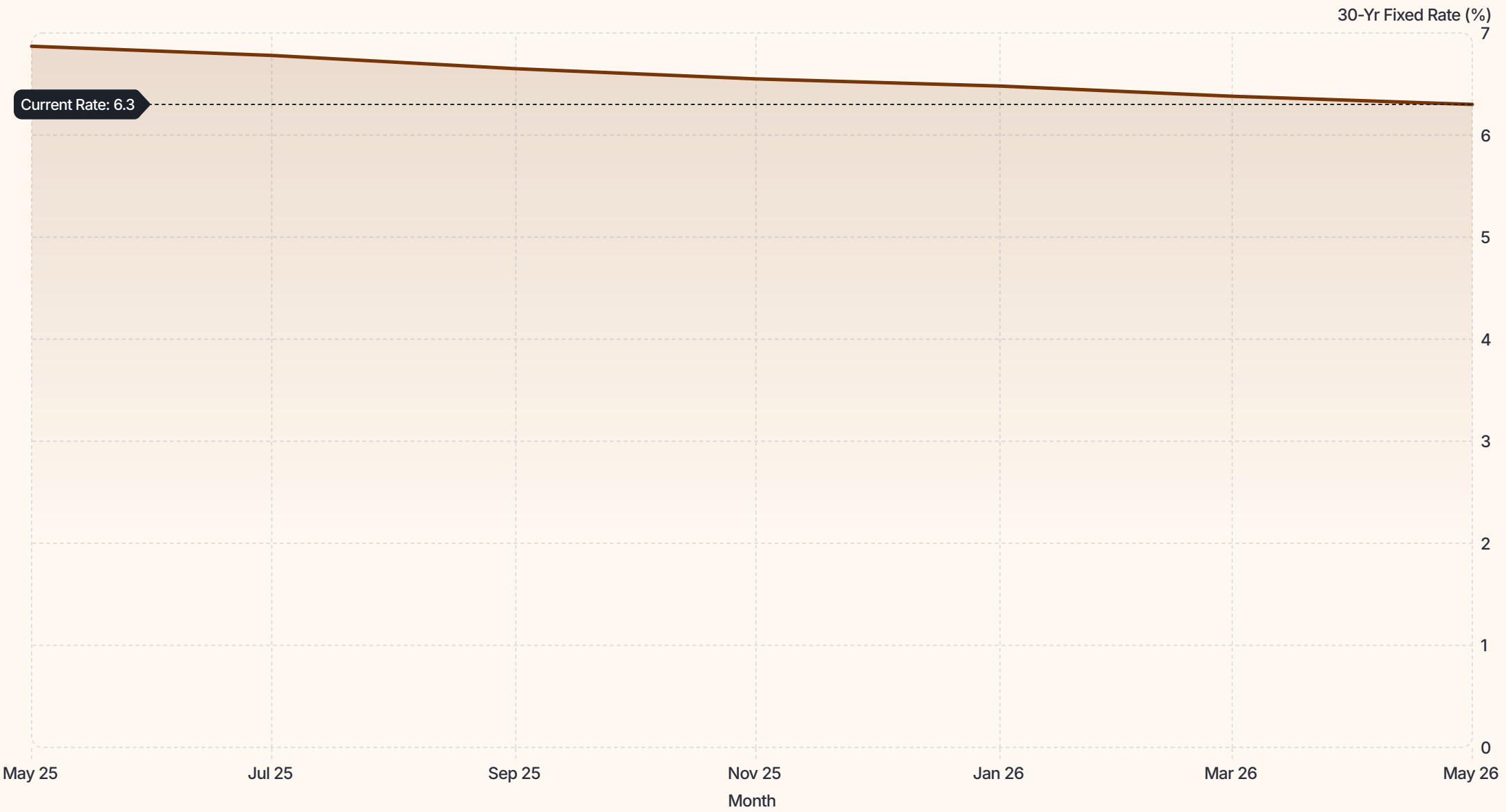
6.30%

Current Rate
30-yr fixed

-57bps

vs. Last Year
Down from 6.87%

Rates at **3-year lows** — NAR notes housing is the most affordable since March 2022.





PAYMENT IMPACT

\$485K Payment Impact: This Month vs. Last Year

April 2025 — 6.87%

P&I: ~\$3,192/mo

20% down on \$485,000

May 2026 — 6.30%

P&I: ~\$3,013/mo

20% down on \$485,000

Monthly Savings

~\$179/mo

Annual Impact

~\$2,148/yr

Single-Family Price-Point Breakdown

Price Band	Inventory (Mo)	DOM	% of List	Closed	Insight
<\$250K	1.2	12	102%	8	Very tight, high competition
\$250K–\$350K	1.8	15	101%	18	Strong demand, fast-moving
\$350K–\$500K	2.4	18	101%	32	Core market, most activity
\$500K–\$700K	3.1	22	100%	19	Balanced, buyer leverage emerging
\$700K–\$1M	4.2	28	99%	7	Slower, negotiation possible
\$1M+	5.8	35	97%	3	Buyer's market conditions

📌 Opportunities & Risks: Entry-level remains fiercely competitive; luxury segment offers negotiating room for buyers



BUYER/SELLER GUIDE

What It Means: Buyers | Sellers

For Buyers

- **Be Prepared:** Homes still sell above list
- **Get Pre-Approved:** Lock in 6.30% rates now
- **Act Quickly:** Good homes move fast

For Sellers

- **Excellent Timing:** 19.1% price appreciation
- **Price Correctly:** Buyers have more choices
- **Present Well:** Staging drives top offers

RapidStats Data Summary

Median Price

\$485,000

+19.1% YoY

Days on Market

20 days

+15 days YoY

Sale-to-List

101.0%

+0.6% YoY

Months' Supply

2.7 months

+0.8 mo YoY

Inventory

239 units

+27.8% YoY

New Listings

164 homes

+40.2% YoY

Closed Sales

87 transactions

-9.4% YoY

Mortgage Rate

6.30%

-0.57% YoY

Recent Headlines

1

Housing Most Affordable Since March 2022

NAR reports wage growth outpacing price increases, combined with lower rates, has improved affordability nationally.

2

Washington County Leads WI Job Growth

Largest year-over-year employment growth (+1.2%) among all Wisconsin counties, Dec 2023–Dec 2024.

3

National Sales Decline 8.4% — Local Holds Stronger

National existing home sales fell to 3.91M annualized; Washington County's 9.4% decline outperforms the national trend.

Sources: RapidStats MLS Reports · Freddie Mac PMMS · NAR Existing Home Sales · BLS LAUS · BLS QCEW · U.S. Census ACS — Washington County, May 2026

NEXT STEPS

Ready to Make Your Move?

Main Takeaways for Buyers

- Lock in 6.30% rates — 3-year lows
- More inventory, less frenzy — act smart

Main Takeaways for Sellers

- 19.1% appreciation — excellent time to sell
- Price strategically in expanding inventory

Contact me for a consultation or the full report!

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Schedule Consultation